



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Trinity Classical School
School Website: <https://trinitybham.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Trinity Classical School WA 98225 (Trinity Bellingham) presents a strong CLASSICAL orientation across all six classical-education categories. The school explicitly grounds its program in Christian theology, treats education as formation in virtue and wisdom, centers the Trivium and Quadrivium within a Great Books framework, and embraces a pedagogy that includes Socratic dialogue, memorization/recitation, and contemplative "Scholé" as part of a living-curriculum approach. Public materials repeatedly emphasize partnership with families, parent formation, and open accessibility for visits, aligning with classical-community norms. Across Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community, Trinity demonstrates explicit classical markers (truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; Great Books; Trivium/Quadrivium; Socratic dialogue; singing/chanting memory work; living teachers; parent partnership). The aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The mission states that "the lordship of Jesus Christ shapes every aspect of the education" and that classical education is an organic, gospel-centered fruit of the Christian worldview.
- The site describes a "Gospel Culture," a "Liturgy of the Day," and a "Christian Worldview" that shapes learning and community life.
- The Trivium/Quadrivium and "Training in Wisdom" are presented within a Christ-centered framework with teachers as living embodiments of that wisdom.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; gospel culture; wisdom; Logos; sacred tradition; contemplation; wonder. These terms appear directly in the public materials.
- Negative keywords: None evident in public materials (no strong secular/relativist signals; no "values clarification" or secular-humanism framing observed). The materials consistently affirm transcendentals and a theocentric worldview.
- Why this rating
- The materials foreground a transcendental, theological foundation (Christ-forming formation, gospel culture, liturgical practices) and a clear integration of theology with all disciplines, aligning with the Positive keywords in the Six Elements lexicon. The absence of secular-relativist signals supports CLASSICAL.

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials describe formation and virtue as core aims, with an emphasis on Christ-centered formation and the Great Books/cultural mission (pursuit of truth, beauty, and goodness as real and knowable). The mission emphasizes formation in character and affections rather than mere information.
- The parent-message materials frame education as a partnership with parents to form “passionate learners who pursue truth, beauty, and goodness” through a classical approach.
- A stated programmatic emphasis on language, math excellence, and formation through the Trivium/Quadrivium aligns with a teleological aim toward human excellence and wisdom.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education/paideia, telos, pursuit of truth/-goodness/beauty, human excellence, scholé, contemplation. These are reflected in mission statements and program descriptions.
- Negative keywords: Not evident; no emphasis on workforce-prep or job-readiness as primary goals per public materials. The focus remains formation/the true good.
- Why this rating
- The school's stated aims center on formation, virtue, wisdom, and transcendentals, with education framed as formation rather than information. This matches CLASSICAL principles per the lexical framework.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The curriculum centers on the seven liberal arts (Trivium: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium: arithmetic, geometry, science, music) and a Great Books/Great Conversation approach to Western civilization. The materials explicitly connect to primary texts and the great conversation rather than reduced or purely social-studies framing.
- References to memorization and chanting in the grammar stage, as well as history integrated across the sequence, align with classical-curriculum expectations.
- Public statements emphasize “great books,” historical engagement, and the unity of disciplines (integration across history, literature, philosophy, and sciences).
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts; Trivium; Quadrivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation; history; memorization; chanting; unity of truth across disciplines; interdisciplinary/harmonious approach; wonder/integration.
- Negative keywords: None of the typical “project-based/experiential-learning-first” signals are present in the core curriculum materials; the materials emphasize traditional structure and primary texts.
- Why this rating
- The explicit centrality of the Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, and integrated, wonder-filled study places the school firmly within classical-curriculum norms.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Pedagogical descriptions include Socratic dialogue/seminars in the upper grades, a strong emphasis on memorization/recitation (singing, chanting, memory work), and a holistic formation through imitation and practice. Public materials show a continuum from grammar-stage singing/chanting to logic-stage dialectic and rhetoric-stage oratory.
- The logic school explicitly describes Socratic discussion and debate, with students engaging in disciplined dialogue and reasoning.
- The public-facing “Scholé” concept and contemplative/restful-learning rhetoric is present, indicating a balanced pace rather than relentless rigor.

- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue/seminar; dialectic; great conversation; guided discussion; memory work; recitation; chanting; imitation; master-teacher models; Scholé; contemplative learning; wonder-based education; unity of knowledge across disciplines; rhetoric/declamation; upper-school rhetoric training.
- Negative keywords: No explicit emphasis on purely experiential/project-based learning; no “constructivist-only” signaling observed in public materials. Limited to absence rather than explicit signals of negative pedagogy.
- Why this rating
- The program description aligns with classical pedagogy from early grammar recitation through upper-school Socratic seminars and rhetorical training, with a Restful-Scholé cadence. This is a clear CLASSICAL pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Text emphasizes teachers as living curriculum, model teachers and mentors, and a collegial, “faculty of friends” culture. This is reinforced by statements about teachers embodying wisdom in the classroom and guiding students through classical disciplines.
- The presence of mentorship-style language and a “portrait of a teacher”/living curriculum aligns with classical-faculty norms described in the knowledge base.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: living curriculum; model teachers; mentors; teachers as guides; portrait of a teacher; collegiality; wisdom in the classroom.
- Negative keywords: None observed in public materials (no “certification-driven jargon” or “facilitator-as-status” signals).
- Why this rating
- The explicit framing of faculty as the core of the curriculum and as virtuous exemplars, along with a collegial culture, matches CLASSICAL expectations for the faculty category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school presents education as a partnership with parents: “education is a partnership with parents” and “parents as co-educators” with opportunities for reading, seminars, and book studies. Public materials emphasize parent involvement and open visits.
- Materials promote parent formation and family involvement, and encourage parental participation through events, home-school alignment, and community engagement.
- The public content highlights routines (parent tours, admissions process, and book studies) that welcome parental engagement.
- Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families; co-teachers; parental formation; reading groups; seminars; home-centered learning; family involvement; parent engagement; open campus; school-parent synergy.
- Negative keywords: Not evident; there is no strong consumer/customer-only framing; rather, a collaborative approach with families is articulated.
- Why this rating
- The materials consistently emphasize family partnership, parental formation, and openness to visits, aligning well with classical-community expectations for parent and community involvement.

Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL

- All six categories meet CLASSICAL criteria based on keyword presence, textual evidence, and alignment with the Six Essential Elements framework.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable (No SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL results). The school already demonstrates robust CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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